

Lepidotes

This bony fish appears to have been a food choice of a ferocious dinosaur called *Baryonyx*, as a number of *Lepidotes* scales and bones have been found in the fossilized stomach area of this dinosaur. It was quite big itself, reaching lengths of up to 6 ft (1.8 m), and it was widespread—fossil remains have been found all over the world.



▲ TEETH

Looking like little stones when fossilized, *Lepidotes*' teeth were once known as "roadstones" and were thought to have magical properties.

Lepidotes

leppy-DOE-tees



- **When** 199—70 million years ago (Jurassic to Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Worldwide
- **Habitat** Lakes of the northern hemisphere
- **Length** 6 ft (1.8 m)

Fabulous *Lepidotes* fossils have been found, with clear skin impressions. *Lepidotes* had thick, diamond-shaped scales. In life, this fish would have had a glossy appearance, thanks to a hard coating over the scales that reflected light.

